SUBJECT–VERB AGREEMENT MASTERCLASS

Module 1: Singular & Plural Foundations • Dasar Subjek Tunggal & Jamak

PART 1 OF 5

SECTION 1 THE CORE RULE & VERB BEHAVIOR

Basic Principle: A singular subject requires a singular verb; a plural subject requires a plural verb.
Prinsip Dasar: Subjek tunggal membutuhkan kata kerja tunggal, sedangkan subjek jamak membutuhkan kata kerja jamak.

Crucial Tense Mechanics (Aturan S-V Present Tense):
- **Nouns:** Add *-s/-es* to form plural (e.g., student → student**s**).
- **Verbs:** Add *-s/-es* to form singular (e.g., walk → walk**s**).
- **Exceptions:** Pronouns *I* and *YOU* take base verbs without *-s* (e.g., *I write, You write*).

1.1 REGULAR & IRREGULAR PLURAL NOUNS

Category	Plural Formation Rule	Singular Form	Plural Form	Sentence Example
Regular (-s / -es)	Add *-s* or *-es* after s, sh, ch, x, z	book, bus, match	book**s**, bus**es**, match**es**	The **buses arrive** on schedule.
Vowel Shift (Irregular)	Internal vowel change (no *-s*)	man, foot, tooth	m**e**n, f**ee**t, t**ee**th	Those **men work** diligently.
En / Ren Endings	Irregular plural suffix	child, ox	child**ren**, ox**en**	The **children play** in the park.
Latin & Greek Origins	Foreign singular/plural endings	datum, cactus, crisis	dat**a**, cact**i**, cris**es**	These **data show** clear results.
Identical Forms	No change between Sing. & Plural	sheep, deer, species	sheep, deer, species	One sheep **is** / Ten sheep **are**.

1.2 COUNTABLE VS. UNCOUNTABLE NOUNS

Noun Class	Grammatical Rule	Word Examples	Verb Agreement Example
Countable Singular	Takes Singular Verb	apple, computer, idea, doctor	The **computer is** operating well.
Countable Plural	Takes Plural Verb	apples, computers, ideas, doctors	The **computers are** operating well.
Uncountable (Mass Nouns)	**Always Singular**	water, rice, milk, coffee, oil	Fresh **water is** essential for survival.
Abstract / Concept Nouns	**Always Singular**	information, advice, knowledge, news	This **information is** accurate.
Aggregate Material Nouns	**Always Singular**	furniture, luggage, equipment, traffic	Heavy **luggage weighs** down the vehicle.

SUBJECT–VERB AGREEMENT MASTERCLASS

Module 2: Compound Subjects • Subjek Majemuk (AND, OR, NOR)

PART 2 OF 5

SECTION 2 STANDARD COMPOUND SUBJECTS

A compound subject consists of two or more nouns or pronouns joined by a conjunction. The verb form depends on whether the items are combined or presented as alternatives.
Subjek majemuk terdiri dari dua atau lebih kata benda yang dihubungkan kata hubung.

Connector	Grammatical Rule	Example Sentence	Penjelasan Bahasa
Subjek A + AND + Subjek B	Takes a **Plural Verb**	Mark **and** David **are** studying.	Dua entitas digabung menjadi subjek jamak.
OR / NOR / EITHER...OR	Agrees with the **Closest Subject**	Either the manager **or** the **staff members are** responsible.	Kata kerja mengikuti 'staff members' (jamak).
NEITHER...NOR	Agrees with the **Closest Subject**	Neither the players **nor** the **coach is** happy.	Kata kerja mengikuti 'coach' (tunggal).
NOT ONLY...BUT ALSO	Agrees with the **Closest Subject**	Not only the students **but also** the **teacher was** present.	Kata kerja mengikuti 'teacher' (tunggal).

SECTION 2.1 DEEP DIVE: TRICKY COMPOUND SUBJECTS

1. Single Concept / Compound Dishes

When two nouns connected by *and* refer to a single dish, unit, or concept, use a **Singular Verb**.

- **Bread and butter is** my daily breakfast.
- **Peanut butter and jelly is** delicious.
- **Law and order is** essential for peace.
- **Slow and steady wins** the race.

2. Same Person / Dual Role

If two titles joined by *and* refer to the **same person** (one article used), use a **Singular Verb**.

- **My friend and mentor is** here. (1 person)
- **The owner and manager speaks** now. (1 person)

Compare: **My friend and my mentor are** here. (2 separate people)

SECTION 2.2 ADVANCED COMPOUND EXCEPTIONS

Special Structure	Verb Rule	Correct Sentence Example
Preceded by "EACH" or "EVERY"	Always **Singular Verb**	**Every** boy and girl **has** a textbook.
Plural Noun + "EACH" (Subject)	Always **Plural Verb**	The students **each have** their own desk.
Mathematical Operations	Usually **Singular Verb**	Two and two **equals** four. / Five times five **is** 25.

Summary Rule for Proximity (Or/Nor): Always look at the noun immediately adjacent to the verb! If the closest noun is singular, use a singular verb; if plural, use a plural verb.

SUBJECT–VERB AGREEMENT MASTERCLASS

Module 3: Indefinite Pronouns • Kata Ganti Tak Tentu & SANAM

PART 3 OF 5

SECTION 3 INDEFINITE PRONOUN CATEGORIES

Indefinite pronouns do not refer to a specific person or thing. They are classified into strictly singular, strictly plural, or variable based on context.
Kata ganti tak tentu dikelompokkan menjadi tunggal mutlak, jamak mutlak, atau bervariasi.

Category	List of Indefinite Pronouns	Verb Required	Sentence Example
Always Singular	everyone, everybody, everything, someone, somebody, something, anyone, anybody, anything, no one, nobody, nothing, each, every, either, neither, one	**Singular Verb**	**Everyone is** expecting good news. **Nobody knows** the answer.
Always Plural	both, few, many, several, others	**Plural Verb**	**Both** options **are** viable. **Several have** applied for the job.

SECTION 3.1 FULL "SANAM" WORD-BY-WORD BREAKDOWN

For **SANAM** pronouns (**S**ome, **A**ny, **N**one, **A**ll, **M**ost), look strictly at the noun in the *of-phrase*!

SANAM Letter	Uncountable Noun (Singular Verb)	Countable Plural Noun (Plural Verb)
S - Some	Some of the **sugar is** spilled.	Some of the **cookies are** missing.
A - Any	Is any of the **paper left**?	Are any of the **reports finished**?
N - None	None of the **work has** been done.	None of the **employees have** left.
A - All	All of the **furniture was** sold.	All of the **chairs were** sold.
M - Most	Most of the **time is** wasted.	Most of the **students pass** the exam.

SECTION 3.2 SPECIAL CASES: "NONE" & "EACH" DEEP DIVE

Word	Formal Grammar Standard	Practical Application & Analysis
EACH	Strictly Singular	Even when followed by a plural prepositional phrase, *Each* takes a singular verb. • **Correct:** Each of the answers **is** correct. • **Incorrect:** ~~Each of the answers are correct.~~
NONE	Meaning Dependent ("Not one" vs "Not any")	• If *None* means "not one single item/person", formal style permits singular. • In standard testing, follow the **SANAM rule** (Noun in *of-phrase* controls the verb).

Memory Shortcut: "EACH of..." and "EVERY ONE of..." ALWAYS take a singular verb. Do not let the plural noun after 'of' confuse you!

SUBJECT–VERB AGREEMENT MASTERCLASS

Module 4: Collective Nouns & Intervening Phrases • Frasa Penyela

PART 4 OF 5

SECTION 4 COLLECTIVE NOUNS (TUNGGAL VS JAMAK)

A **Collective Noun** refers to a group acting as a single entity or as individual members acting separately (e.g., *team, family, committee, class, audience, jury, staff, army*).
Kata benda kolektif tergantung apakah anggota bertindak bersama atau individu terpisah.

Context	Unit Action (Singular Verb)	Individual Action (Plural Verb)
The Team	The team **wins** every game. (Acting together)	The team **are changing** into their uniforms. (Individually)
The Committee	The committee **has submitted** its report.	The committee **have** different opinions. (Disagreement)
The Family	My family **is** moving to Tokyo. (One unit)	My family **are** arguing about vacation. (Separate)
The Jury	The jury **delivers** the verdict.	The jury **are unable** to reach an agreement.
The Audience	The audience **applauds** loudly.	The audience **are returning** to their seats.

SECTION 5 INTERVENING PHRASES (FRASA PENYELA)

Core Principle: Modifying phrases placed between the subject and verb do **NOT** affect the subject's number. Identify the true subject and mentally cross out the intervening phrase!
Frasa di antara subjek dan kata kerja TIDAK mengubah jumlah subjek. Abaikan frasa penyela.

Intervening Phrase Type	Expression Keywords	Full Sentence Example	True Subject & Verb
Additive Phrases	*along with, together with, as well as, accompanied by*	The teacher, along with her students, **is** attending.	**teacher → is**
Inclusive / Exclusive	*including, in addition to, except, plus, besides*	All members, including the leader, **have** voted.	**members → have**
Prepositional Modifier	*of, in, on, under, between, near, with*	The box of chocolates **was** delivered.	**box → was**
Relative Clauses	*who, which, that*	The scientist who studied the samples **gives** a speech.	**scientist → gives**
Appositive Phrases	Phrases inside commas setting off extra info	Mr. John, a father of three boys, **works** hard.	**Mr. John → works**

Mental Elimination Technique:
Sentence: *"The manager, ~~together with his assistants~~, **is/are** working."*
Eliminate the modifier → **"The manager IS working."**

SUBJECT–VERB AGREEMENT MASTERCLASS

Module 5: Comprehensive Practice & Error Analysis • Latihan Lengkap

PART 5 OF 5

EXERCISE A MULTIPLE CHOICE MASTERY

Choose the correct verb form in parentheses and identify the underlying grammar rule.

1. Neither the manager nor the employees (has / have) agreed to the new policy.
• *Answer:* ***have*** *(Proximity rule: closest subject 'employees' is plural).*

2. The box of old letters and photographs (was / were) found in the attic.
• *Answer:* ***was*** *(True subject is singular 'box'; prepositional phrases are ignored).*

3. Bread and butter (is / are) served as a side dish at this restaurant.
• *Answer:* ***is*** *(Single culinary concept / item).*

4. Most of the equipment (was / were) damaged during transit.
• *Answer:* ***was*** *(SANAM rule: 'equipment' is an uncountable aggregate noun).*

EXERCISE B ERROR ANALYSIS & CORRECTION

Identify the error in each sentence and provide the correct verb form with explanation.

Sentence 1: "Each of the candidates have submitted their resume."
• **Correction:** Change have to **has**.
• **Reason:** *'Each'* is an indefinite pronoun that is strictly singular.

Sentence 2: "The professor, as well as his students, were surprised by the test results."
• **Correction:** Change were to **was**.
• **Reason:** *'as well as his students'* is an intervening phrase; true subject is *'professor'*.

Sentence 3: "Ten miles are a long distance to walk in the heat."
• **Correction:** Change are to **is**.
• **Reason:** Expressions of time, distance, or money are treated as a single quantity.

Final Exam Tip: When analyzing complex sentences: (1) Find the main verb, (2) Ask "WHO or WHAT is doing this action?", (3) Strip out prepositional phrases and clauses, (4) Match the core subject with its singular/plural verb form.